Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

EA300A
Children's Literature (I)
ALL BRACHES

MIDTERM ASSESSMENT (MAIN)
2024-2025 / Spring Semester
Date: 8 April 2025
12:00 – 2:00

umber of Exam Pages: 4 cluding this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

STRUCTION

There are TWO sections in this exam paper:

1. You are required to answer <u>two</u> questions from <u>Section 1</u>, and <u>One</u> question from <u>Section 2</u>.
2. Answers in Section 1 should be in the form of short answers.
3. Answers in section 2 should be in standard essay format: Start with a thesis, end with a conclusion, define all important terms, and provide specific and appropriate examples. Analyze and discuss the examples.
4. Edit your answers, paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
5. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
6. It is also necessary to refer to relevant critical essays to support your analysis.

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SECTION 1: SHORT ANSWERS **(10 marks)**

Answer TWO of the following three questions in 50 words each.

1. **In the traditional tale, *Little Red Riding Hood* is often depicted as innocent and naive, while Roald Dahl's version presents her as witty and resourceful, capable of outsmarting the wolf". Comment. (5 marks)**

2. **"In the modern version of the tale 'Little Red Riding Hood and the Wolf', the absence of the male rescuer affects the message of male heroism and female agency". Comment. (5 marks)**

3. **"In L. M. Alcott's *Little Women*, Beth's character functions symbolically within the novel. She embodies a deeper critique of the idealized 'angel in the house'". Comment. (5 marks)**

SECTION 2: ESSAY WRITING/ CLOSE READING **(20 MARKS)**

Answer EITHER Question 1 OR Question 2 in 250 WORDS.

Question 1: ESSAY WRITING

"Laurie's failure to marry Jo and eventual match with Amy reflect societal norms about class, gender, and romantic idealism." Would Laurie and Jo's marriage have subverted expectations? Discuss with reference to specific episodes from the novel and to critics' views on the topic.

OR

Question 2: CLOSE READING

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Analyze the following passage from L. M. Alcott's *Little Women* focusing on Jo's ability to create her own happiness and success.

Aunt March died suddenly. But when their first sorrow was over—for they loved the old lady in spite of her sharp tongue—they found they had cause for rejoicing, for she had left Plumfield to Jo, which made all sorts of joyful things possible.

'It's a fine old place, and will bring a handsome sum, for of course you intend to sell it,' said Laurie, as they were all talking the matter over some weeks later.

'No, I don't,' was Jo's decided answer, as she petted the fat poodle, whom she had adopted, out of respect to his former mistress.

'You don't mean to live there?'

'Yes, I do.'

'But, my dear girl, it's an immense house, and will take a power of money to keep it in order. The garden and orchard alone need two or three men, and farming isn't in Bhaer's line, I take it.'

'He'll try his hand at it there, if I propose it.'

'And you expect to live on the produce of the place? Well, that sounds paradisiacal, but you'll find it desperate hard work.'

'The crop we are going to raise is a profitable one,' And Jo laughed.

'Of what is this fine crop to consist, ma'am?'

'Boys. I want to open a school for little lads—a good, happy, homelike school, with me to take care of them and Fritz to teach them.'

'That's a truly Joian plan for you! Isn't that just like her?' cried Laurie, appealing to the family, who looked as much surprised as he.

'I like it,' said Mrs. March decidedly.

'So do I,' added her husband, who welcomed the thought of a chance for trying the Socratic method of education on modern youth.

'It will be an immense care for Jo,' said Meg, stroking the head or her one all-absorbing son. 'Jo can do it and be happy in it. It's a splendid idea. Tell us all about it,' cried Mr. Laurence, who had been longing to lend the lovers a hand, but knew that they would refuse his help.

***Little Women* (1868) p. 844-5**

End of Exam

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